



ANUPRIYA ACHARYA
54, CEO, Publicis Groupe, South Asia

DIGITAL FIRST

ABOUT TWO YEARS before the pandemic, Anupriya Acharya and her team at Publicis Groupe, South Asia saw an opportunity to build capabilities in e-commerce. “The approach has always been to invest ahead of time,” she says. That came good during the pandemic, as people ordered pretty much everything online. In a world where technology is indispensable, the smart thing is to get the best

out of it. “Agility is very important and we spend a lot of time on areas like AI and GenAI,” says Acharya, who is CEO of Publicis Groupe, South Asia. Going ahead, Acharya and her organisation will continue to focus on technology and look for ways to address customer needs. That’s a good place to be in. **BT**

— **BY KRISHNA GOPALAN**

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Resilience and adaptability are vital

DOING IT RIGHT

FOR ARATHI KRISHNA, MD of Sundram Fasteners, “to be powerful in the real meaning of the word is to treat everyone with justice and ethics.” The 56-year-old, who joined Sundram Fasteners as a trainee in 1990, has spearheaded the company’s strong global expansion in both auto and non-auto sectors despite the cyclicity of the business, the global recession of 2008, and the impact of Covid-19.

For Krishna, the main focus has always been growing the company at double-digit annualised rates and to encourage home-grown talent within the organisation.

“The loyalty and goodwill of my employees have been the foundation and real achievement of my career,” says Krishna.

Despite leading the company in a male-dominated sector, Krishna acknowledges that the participation of women in the manufacturing sector is quite low, unlike in sectors like banking and IT. “We are predominantly in a traditional manufacturing industry with low female participation. I have striven hard to increase the participation of the female workforce,” says Krishna. She says that’s changing now with government support.



ARATHI KRISHNA
56, Managing Director, Sundram Fasteners Limited

Going ahead, the company aims to become the most trusted and innovative auto components player in the domestic market. “We are rapidly evolving from a component manufacturer to a supplier of sub-assemblies for EV players. We are working

to increase our exports to non-auto sectors and to provide new and innovative parts in the auto sector to achieve scale,” says Krishna. With all that she’s managed to achieve, you wouldn’t bet against her. **BT**

— **BY ASTHA ORIEL**

ADVICE TO YOUR YOUNGER SELF

Always build your skills to be future ready

MANTRA TO NAVIGATE CHALLENGES

Lose your ego and never be afraid to ask questions